

HOW TO SPEAK ENGLISH LIKE A NATIVE SPEAKER

KEITH O'HARE



Helping you Become a Confident English Speaker

Many IELTS students lack confidence in their speaking skills.

The Keith Speaking Academy helps you develop your speaking skills so you can face the examiner with confidence and ace the IELTS test.

This PDF is one of many that Keith has developed to help you do this.



Keith has been working in international education for over 20 years as a teacher, teacher trainer, and education manager.

He has helped over 40,000 students prepare for their IELTS Speaking test with his online courses.

Do you sometimes find native English speakers can't understand you?

Would you like to speak English more like a native speaker?

If so, keep reading this PDF, and I will have you speaking more like a native speaker in 20 minutes.

This will not only help boost your confidence, but also help you get a higher score in IELTS Speaking.

Let's do it.



How native speakers actually speak English

When native English speakers start talking, they do a lot of things with words that you cannot see in the written word.

These include:

- **Connecting or Linking words**

Get up = get_up

- **Using contractions**

I will = I'll

- **Adding sounds**

Go away = go-w-away

- **Dropping sounds**

I must go = I mus-go

- **Changing sounds** when 2 words come together.

Don't you = donchu .../dəʊntʃu:/

- **Leaving out whole words**

I am going to the pub, are you coming? = I am going to the pub, coming?

In this lesson, we will focus on pronunciation and fluency. I will help you hear and practice some of the most common examples where natural native English speaking is different from the words you see in a book.

Linking words in common questions

When you read a sentence, you will probably read it word by word, for example,

What – do – you – do?

But actually, native English speakers link all words together, so it sounds like this

- *Wadeje do?*

This is what we say when we want to know what someone's job is. Likewise, for this question,

What – do – you – want?

We would say,

- *Wadeje wan?*

You might say this if someone is annoying or interrupting you, and also if you want to know what a friend wants to eat or drink in a restaurant.

Here are some more examples with common questions.

What – are – you – doing?

- *Wadeje doin?*

What – are – you – up – to?

- *Wadeje wupto?*

What – are – you – having?

- *Wadeje havin?*

The latter might be said again when asking a friend what they want to eat or drink in a bar or restaurant.

In the following questions, we change the sounds between the words.

Do – you – want – a – coffee?

- *Djewana coffee?*

Would – you – like – a – coffee?

- *Wudjelika coffee?*



Dropping sounds when using 'he'

When we use the third person singular '**HE**' after an auxiliary verb, (e.g. does, was, has) we often drop the **/h/** sound.

See the examples of how the sounds change below.

Does – he – like – it?

- *Duzi likit?*

Was – he – happy?

- *Wuzi happy?*

Has – he – called – you?

- *Huzi calledju?*

Can I use wanna and gonna in IELTS speaking?

The simple answer is YES!

Gonna and Wanna are contractions and in IELTS Speaking you should be using contractions because they are a part of natural spoken English.

Let's have a look at these contractions, and some more, with examples.

I – am – going – to – go

- *amgonna go*

I – want – to – go

- *awanna go*

Shall – we – go?

- *Shwe go?*

To express a **regret** we can say;

I – should – have – gone

- *ashude gone*

To express a **possibility in the past** we can say;

I – could – have – gone

- *akude gone*

Be clear about your goal

Next, I want to be clear that your goal does **not** have to be, to sound exactly like a native speaker.

There is no need – you can be a C1 advanced or C2 proficient level speaker, without sounding exactly like a native.

In fact, it's a model that is impossible for most people and may lead to frustration.

No, my message is;

Try to sound **more** like a native speaker; to use more natural pronunciation features, when you can.

No pressure – just enjoy playing with these sounds.

It's about practice – not perfection!

Find out more information about IELTS Speaking here:

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